

Understanding Various Majorities in Parliament with Example

Total Membership (Strength) of the House – 545

No. of Members resigned/died (and bye-election not yet organized for their seat) – 4

No. of Members disqualified from the House – 3

Attendance on two particular instances:

Day	Present	Voting	Abstentions
Day 1	300	270	30
Day 2	500	480	20

Minimum number of Votes required for respective Bills/Motions to be passed in the House:

S. No.	Type of Majority	Examples in Constitution of India	Explanation	Minimum Votes needed to Pass the Bill/Motion
1	Simple Majority	Confidence Motion Passage of Ordinary Bill, Budget etc.	Majority of the members present and voting	Day 1: 50% plus 1 of 270 = 136 Day 2: 50% plus 1 of 480 = 241
2.	Absolute Majority	Never required on its own; always along with other types of majority	Majority of the total membership of the House	Day 1: 50% plus 1 of 545 = 273 Day 2: 50% plus 1 of 545 = 273
3.	Effective Majority	Removal of all presiding officers in their House	Majority of the effective strength of the House (i.e. Total Strength minus vacancies)	Day 1: 50% plus one of (545 – 4 – 3) = 269 votes Day 2: same as Day 1
4A.	Special Majority like Article 249	A249, A312	Majority of not less than 2/3 of the members present and voting	Day 1: 2/3 of 270 = 180 votes Day 2: 2/3 of 480 = 320 votes
4B.	Special Majority like Article 368	A368, resolution to approve Emergency (A352), Removal of Judges (A124)	Majority of the total membership and by a majority of not less than 2/3 of members present and voting	Day 1: 50% plus 1 of 545 = 273; AND 2/3 of 270 = 180 votes So, at least 273. Day 2: 50% plus 1 of 545 = 273; AND 2/3 of 480 = 320 votes So, at least 320.
4C.	Special Majority like Article 61	Only A61 – Impeachment of President of India	Majority of not less than 2/3 of the total membership	Day 1: 2/3 of 545 = 363 votes Day 2: Same as Day 1

majority of all the then members of House.